JavaScript is disabled on your browser.

**Java SE 27 & JDK 27**

# Class Annotation

java.lang.Object
    java.text.Annotation

---

```
public class Annotation
extends Object
```

An Annotation object is used as a wrapper for a text attribute value if the attribute has annotation characteristics. These characteristics are:

- The text range that the attribute is applied to is critical to the semantics of the range. That means, the attribute cannot be applied to subranges of the text range that it applies to, and, if two adjacent text ranges have the same value for this attribute, the attribute still cannot be applied to the combined range as a whole with this value.
- The attribute or its value usually do no longer apply if the underlying text is changed.

An example is grammatical information attached to a sentence: For the previous sentence, you can say that "an example" is the subject, but you cannot say the same about "an", "example", or "exam". When the text is changed, the grammatical information typically becomes invalid. Another example is Japanese reading information (yomi).

Wrapping the attribute value into an Annotation object guarantees that adjacent text runs don't get merged even if the attribute values are equal, and indicates to text containers that the attribute should be discarded if the underlying text is modified.

**Since:**

1.2

**See Also:**

`AttributedCharacterIterator`

## *Constructor Summary*

**Constructors**

| Constructor | Description |
|---|---|
| `Annotation(Object value)` | Constructs an annotation record with the given value, which may be null. |

## Method Summary

| All Methods | Instance Methods | |
|---|---|---|

| Modifier and Type | Method | Description |
|---|---|---|
| Object | **getValue**() | Returns the value of the attribute, which may be null. |
| String | **toString**() | Returns the String representation of this Annotation. |

**Methods declared in class Object**

clone, equals, finalize, getClass, hashCode, notify, notifyAll, wait, wait, wait

## Constructor Details

### Annotation

```
public Annotation(Object value)
```

Constructs an annotation record with the given value, which may be null.

**Parameters:**

value - the value of the attribute

## Method Details

### getValue

```
public Object getValue()
```

Returns the value of the attribute, which may be null.

**Returns:**

the value of the attribute

### toString

```
public String toString()
```

Returns the String representation of this Annotation.

**Overrides:**

`toString` in class `Object`

**Returns:**

the `String` representation of this `Annotation`

---

Report a bug or suggest an enhancement
For further API reference and developer documentation see the Java SE Documentation, which contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples. Other versions.
Java is a trademark or registered trademark of Oracle and/or its affiliates in the US and other countries.
Copyright © 1993, 2026, Oracle and/or its affiliates, 500 Oracle Parkway, Redwood Shores, CA 94065 USA.
All rights reserved. Use is subject to license terms and the documentation redistribution policy.

Scripting on this page tracks web page traffic, but does not change the content in any way.